# Welcome Note

Professor Dr. Shawky Salem

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## The Launch of "LIBRARIAN A"

## المكتبي A

This product reflects the spirit of ambition and challenge which characterizes Alex Centre for Multimedia & Libraries (ACML). Recently, ACML took upon itself the responsibility to provide an Arabic product that electronically manages the functions of libraries and information centers.

For over fifteen years that represent ACML's marketing of global systems for Library Management Systems in Egypt, such as the "Horizon" (now called SYMPHONY system), VIRTUA (by VTLS) that is currently implemented at the Library of Alexandria and others, ACML has been trying in every way possible to produce Arabic small and medium size versions of these global systems to meet the needs of the Arabic libraries and information centers, especially libraries of small and medium size; but those in charge of these global systems entirely rejected the idea because they wanted to cater for giant libraries only.

ACML decided to study this project and provided budgets and set unprecedented preparations to produce an Arabic full-fledged system that includes all the functions and specifications of the international systems, but is cost-effective to fit Arab region requirements; and in addition, the system addresses all levels of libraries from small to medium to large size.

ACML tried to identify software companies who can help in this area in India, biggest software producer worldwide, and settled its choice on one of India's giant technology companies "Growth, and its affiliate companies". An agreement between ACML and Growth has been signed to allow Growth to fulfill the needs of the Arabic Library market. Over two years of regular and accurate work, the first version "1.0" of the new electronic library management system, named LIBRARIAN A", came to light.

"Growth" distributed LIBRARIAN A in Asia, while ACML distributed it in the Arab region. Both companies kept their eligibility rights to develop the software according to international developments in the expanding area of information technology and e-content.

During 2010 and 2011, ACML continued to develop the second version "1.1" of "LIBRARIAN" and called it "LIBRARIAN A المكتبي", in three languages: **Arabic, English and French**, with the help of purely Egyptian hands, under the supervision of a group of selected professors of Library and Information Science (LIS) and with the help of experts in sophisticated software development.

ACML is really proud to offer this product to Egypt and the Arab region. This software is built on **latest trends** in programming and information technology, and it implements all **international standards** relevant to this area. ACML hopes that this important and effective software product helps in the development of libraries and information centers in the Arab World. ACML also hopes that this product enables libraries move to the stage of digital and virtual libraries and the stunning cyberspace navigation of human knowledge.

Heartfelt congratulations to those who selected "LIBRARIAN A" for the electronic management of library functions. It is a robust system that helps you manage the library collections and allows users full access to available information sources, whether paper, electronic, or audio-visual. This intelligent and expert system "LIBRARIAN A" has been designed and developed by a team of highly creative Egyptian experts in order to meet the requirements of libraries and information centers of various types and sizes. A working group was formed of professors of librarianship who are professionals in the area of library automation, and another group of programmers and developers, and another group of devices and systems experts. They all together formed a piece of unique symphony to produce this outstanding tool which will meet the needs of Arabic libraries.

"LIBRARIAN A" system is **user-friendly**, and you will know its features and capabilities better throughout this guide. This integrated automation system addresses the needs of libraries, documentation centers, information centers, archiving centers, data analysis centers, press information centers, economic, financial, scientific and technological information center, and others.

"LIBRARIAN A" is one of the most successful Integrated Library Management Systems (ILMS) for all types of libraries and information centers, not at the local level or at the Arab level only, but at the international level. It applies all international standards and codes and it keeps pace with global developments in its field in the three languages in which it was designed.

This successful system is a result of big efforts, perseverance, and significant investment that the "Alex Centre for Multimedia and Libraries" (ACML) has put in the development of its second version and is a result of the customer support services dedicated to it. "LIBRARIAN A" provides full support to the Arabic language with its requirements in indexing, classification and research. Further, the advanced system support for international services and standards as well as the support for modern computer technologies has contributed to the success of the system's implementation at libraries that acquired it. The system efficiently supports linking different libraries electronically and making them available to beneficiaries through a unified site, making it easier to link a university library with its branch libraries – if there is a need to – in an easy and convenient way.

“LIBRARIAN A" is a result of real efforts and long cooperation that started from early 2007 between the "Alex Centre for Multimedia and Libraries" (ACML), acknowledged companies, and expert professional individuals. In terms of its capabilities, the system is one of the best as it started from where others have ended in sophisticated technologies, software programs, platforms, and database management.

## Professor Dr. Shawky Salem

**ACML Chairman**

***The Medal of Honor,***

***International Federation of Library Associations and Institutions (IFLA)***

***Jason Farradane’s International Award for Distinguished Information Scientists, UKeig-CILIP***

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